

Q1. What is a Decision Tree? Explain its structure with a real-life example.

A **Decision Tree** is a supervised learning algorithm used for both classification and regression. It works by breaking down a dataset into smaller subsets while simultaneously developing an associated decision tree.

- **Structure:**
 - **Root Node:** The very top node representing the entire dataset, which gets split into two or more homogeneous sets.
 - **Decision (Internal) Nodes:** Nodes where further splits occur based on specific features.
 - **Leaf (Terminal) Nodes:** The final nodes that represent the predicted class or value; they do not split further.
- **Real-Life Example:** Deciding whether to play tennis based on the weather. The **Root** might be "Outlook" (Sunny, Overcast, Rainy). If "Sunny," the **Decision Node** checks "Humidity." If humidity is "Normal," the **Leaf Node** is "Yes" (Play).

Q2. Gini Impurity vs. Entropy

- **Gini Impurity:** Measures the frequency at which a randomly chosen element from the set would be incorrectly labeled. It is computationally faster because it doesn't involve logarithmic functions.
- **Entropy:** Measures the degree of "disorder" or uncertainty. It uses a log scale, making it slightly more computationally intensive.
- **Scikit-learn Default:** It uses **Gini Impurity** by default because the results are usually similar to Entropy, but Gini is faster to calculate, leading to better performance on large datasets.

Q3. Overfitting in Decision Trees

Overfitting occurs when a tree becomes too complex, capturing noise and outliers in the training data rather than the general pattern.

- **Detection:** You can detect it by comparing accuracies. If **Training Accuracy is very high** (e.g., 99%) but **Testing Accuracy is significantly lower** (e.g., 70%), the model is overfitted.

Q4. Pruning in Decision Trees

Pruning is the process of removing branches that provide little power to classify instances, thereby reducing complexity and overfitting.

- **Pre-pruning:** Stopping the tree growth early (e.g., setting `max_depth` or `min_samples_split`).
- **Post-pruning:** Allowing the tree to grow fully and then removing nodes that do not significantly improve performance.

Q5. Feature Importance

Feature Importance assigns a score to input features based on how useful they are at predicting the target variable.

- **Business Impact:** It helps businesses identify key drivers of success. For example, a bank might find that "Duration of Call" is the top feature, signaling that staff should focus on engaging customers longer to increase conversion rates.